PANCHAYATI RAJ

FROM DEMOCRATIC DECENTRALISATION TO → PART IX ARCHITECTURE: GRAM → REPRESENTATION, ELECTION, CONTINUITY AND → ARTICLE 243G, ELEVENTH SCHEDULE → FISCAL CONSTITUTION: OWN REVENUE → PESA, SCHEDULED AREAS AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g3 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 FROM DEMOCRATIC DECENTRALISATION TO CONSTITUTIONAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT

FROM DEMOCRATIC DECENTRALISATION TO CONSTITUTIONAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT | ROOT QUESTION | HOW DID VILLAGE ADMINISTRATION BECOME CONSTITUTIONALLY PROTECTED SELF-GOVERNMENT? | ARTICLE 40 | ORGANISE VILLAGE PANCHAYATS AND ENDOW SELF-GOVERNMENT POWERS. | 1957 BALWANT RAI MEHTA | THREE TIERS AND DEMOCRATIC DECENTRALISATION. | 1977-78 ASHOK MEHTA

ROOT QUESTION → How did village administration become constitutionally protected self-government? → ARTICLE 40 → organise village Panchayats and endow self-government powers. → 1957 Balwant Rai Mehta → three tiers and democratic decentralisation. → 1977-78 Ashok Mehta → district-centred two-tier alternative.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ROOT QUESTION
- How did village administration become constitutionally protected self-government?
- ARTICLE 40 → organise village Panchayats and endow self-government powers.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1957 Balwant Rai Mehta → three tiers and democratic decentralisation.
- 1977-78 Ashok Mehta → district-centred two-tier alternative.
- 1985 G.V.K. Rao → district development administration.

CHECK / LIMIT
- 1986 L.M. Singhvi → constitutional status + Gram Sabha.
- 73RD AMENDMENT ACT, 1992
- Part IX + Eleventh Schedule → effective 24 April 1993.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CORE LIMIT constitutional status guarantees democratic form; State law controls devolution substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CORE LIMIT constitutional status guarantees democratic form; State law controls devolution substance.

01

STAGE 01 PART IX ARCHITECTURE: GRAM SABHA, TIERS AND CONSTITUTIONAL EXCEPTIONS

PART IX ARCHITECTURE | GRAM SABHA, TIERS AND CONSTITUTIONAL EXCEPTIONS | PART IX | ARTICLES 243-243O | 243A GRAM SABHA | 243B TIERS | 243C COMPOSITION | 243D RESERVATION

PART IX: ARTICLES 243-243O → 243A Gram Sabha → 243B tiers → 243C composition → 243D reservation

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PART IX: ARTICLES 243-243O
- 243A Gram Sabha
- 243B tiers
- 243C composition
- 243D reservation

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 243E duration
- 243F disqualification
- 243G powers
- 243H finance
- 243I SFC

CHECK / LIMIT
- 243J audit
- 243K SEC
- 243O election bar.
- THREE-TIER DEFAULT district → intermediate → village.
- State population <= 20 lakh may omit only the intermediate tier.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- GRAM SABHA all registered voters in a village area; exact powers come from State law.
- ARTICLE 243H specified Scheduled/tribal and other excluded areas require distinct legal routes.
- PESA, 1996 extends Part IX principles to Fifth Schedule areas with modifications.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PESA, 1996 extends Part IX principles to Fifth Schedule areas with modifications.

02

STAGE 02 REPRESENTATION, ELECTION, CONTINUITY AND RESERVATION CONTROLS

REPRESENTATION, ELECTION, CONTINUITY AND RESERVATION CONTROLS | DEMOCRATIC CYCLE DIRECT ELECTION TO TERRITORIAL SEATS | CHAIRPERSON ROUTE UNDER STATE LAW | FIVE-YEAR TERM | ELECTION BEFORE EXPIRY OR WITHIN SIX MONTHS OF DISSOLUTION. | ARTICLE 243D | SC/ST RESERVATION LINKED TO POPULATION; NOT LESS THAN ONE-THIRD | CHAIRPERSON RESERVATIONS INCLUDE WOMEN AND SC/ST; MANY STATES EXCEED

DEMOCRATIC CYCLE direct election to territorial seats → five-year term → election before expiry or within six months of dissolution. → ARTICLE 243D → SC/ST reservation linked to population; not less than one-third seats for women. → Chairperson reservations include women and SC/ST; many States exceed the floor.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- DEMOCRATIC CYCLE direct election to territorial seats → chairperson route under State law
- five-year term → election before expiry or within six months of dissolution.
- ARTICLE 243D

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SC/ST reservation linked to population; not less than one-third seats for women.
- Chairperson reservations include women and SC/ST; many States exceed the floor.
- ARTICLE 243K

CHECK / LIMIT
- State Election Commission controls Panchayat rolls and elections.
- ARTICLE 243O delimitation/allotment barred from ordinary challenge; election petition is the route.
- TRAPS candidate age floor is 21

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ECI does not conduct Panchayat elections reservation creates access but proxy control can block substantive authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAPS candidate age floor is 21 | ECI does not conduct Panchayat elections reservation creates access but proxy control can block substantive authority.

03

STAGE 03 ARTICLE 243G, ELEVENTH SCHEDULE AND THE THREE-F FUNCTIONALITY TEST

ARTICLE 243G, ELEVENTH SCHEDULE AND THE THREE-F FUNCTIONALITY TEST | ARTICLE 243G IS ENABLING | STATE LEGISLATURE MAY ENDOW PANCHAYATS WITH SELF-GOVERNMENT POWERS. | ELEVENTH SCHEDULE | 29 MATTERS AGRICULTURE/LAND/WATER | RURAL INFRASTRUCTURE | POVERTY ALLEVIATION | COMMUNITY ASSETS.

ARTICLE 243G IS ENABLING → State legislature may endow Panchayats with self-government powers. → ELEVENTH SCHEDULE: 29 MATTERS agriculture/land/water → rural infrastructure → health/education → poverty alleviation → welfare → community assets. → FUNCTIONS clear activity map and tier responsibility.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 243G IS ENABLING
- State legislature may endow Panchayats with self-government powers.
- ELEVENTH SCHEDULE: 29 MATTERS agriculture/land/water → rural infrastructure → health/education

POWER / PROCEDURE
- poverty alleviation → welfare → community assets.
- FUNCTIONS clear activity map and tier responsibility.
- FUNCTIONARIES staff placement, direction and accountability to the elected body.

CHECK / LIMIT
- FINANCES own revenue + assigned revenue + predictable grants + spending discretion.
- FUNCTIONALITY TEST
- Can the Panchayat decide, direct staff, spend and answer publicly for outcomes?

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- poverty alleviation → welfare → community assets.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Can the Panchayat decide, direct staff, spend and answer publicly for outcomes?.

04

STAGE 04 FISCAL CONSTITUTION: OWN REVENUE, SFC, UNION GRANTS AND AUDIT

FISCAL CONSTITUTION | OWN REVENUE, SFC, UNION GRANTS AND AUDIT | ARTICLE 243H | STATE LAW MAY AUTHORISE TAXES/DUTIES/TOLLS/FEES, ASSIGNMENTS, GRANTS AND PANCHAYAT | OWN-SOURCE BASKET PROPERTY/MARKET LEVIES | LICENCE/SERVICE FEES | USER CHARGES | RENTS PONDS/FISHERIES/COMMUNITY ASSETS

ARTICLE 243H

State law may authorise taxes/duties/tolls/fees, assignments, grants and Panchayat Funds. → OWN-SOURCE BASKET property/market levies → licence/service fees

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 243H
- State law may authorise taxes/duties/tolls/fees, assignments, grants and Panchayat Funds.
- OWN-SOURCE BASKET property/market levies
- licence/service fees

POWER / PROCEDURE
- user charges
- rents ponds/fisheries/community assets
- State-law borrowing.
- ARTICLE 243I

CHECK / LIMIT
- Governor constitutes SFC every five years → tax sharing, assignments, grants and measures.
- ARTICLE 280
- Union Finance Commission recommends augmentation of State funds for Panchayats on the basis of SFC recommendations.
- Article 243J accounts/audit → public records → social audit → corrective action.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LIMIT grants equalise capacity but cannot substitute for State tax devolution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT grants equalise capacity but cannot substitute for State tax devolution.

05

STAGE 05 PESA, SCHEDULED AREAS AND COMMUNITY-CENTRED DECISION VERBS

PESA, SCHEDULED AREAS AND COMMUNITY-CENTRED DECISION VERBS | FIFTH SCHEDULE AREA ORDINARY PART IX EXCLUSION UNDER ARTICLE | PESA, 1996 EXTENSION WITH MODIFICATIONS. | PESA GRAM SABHA COMMUNITY RESOURCES + CUSTOMS + CULTURAL | DECISION VERBS MUST STAY DISTINCT CONSULTATION | PRIOR RECOMMENDATION | LAND AND RESOURCES PREVENT ALIENATION + RESTORE UNLAWFULLY ALIENATED | IRA LINK FOREST-RIGHT RECOGNITION AND COMMUNITY FOREST-RESOURCE POWERS OVERLAP.

FIFTH SCHEDULE AREA ordinary Part IX exclusion under Article 243M → PESA, 1996 extension with modifications

PESA GRAM SABHA community resources + customs + cultural identity + customary dispute practices. → DECISION VERBS MUST STAY DISTINCT consultation != recommendation != prior recommendation != approval. → LAND AND RESOURCES prevent alienation + restore unlawfully alienated land minor minerals and markets within the exact statutory allocation.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- FIFTH SCHEDULE AREA ordinary Part IX exclusion under Article 243M → PESA, 1996 extension with modifications.
- PESA GRAM SABHA community resources + customs + cultural identity + customary dispute practices.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- DECISION VERBS MUST STAY DISTINCT consultation != recommendation != prior recommendation != approval.
- LAND AND RESOURCES prevent alienation + restore unlawfully alienated land minor minerals and markets within the exact statutory allocation.

CHECK / LIMIT
- IRA LINK forest-right recognition and community forest-resource powers overlap but do not merge.
- LIMIT PESA is not an unlimited veto over every project or every Scheduled Tribe area.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- FIFTH SCHEDULE AREA ordinary Part IX exclusion under Article 243M → PESA, 1996 extension with modifications.
- PESA GRAM SABHA community resources + customs + cultural identity + customary dispute practices.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT PESA is not an unlimited veto over every project or every Scheduled Tribe area.

06

STAGE 06 PLANNING, ACCOUNTABILITY, DIGITAL TOOLS AND JUDICIAL BOUNDARY

PLANNING, ACCOUNTABILITY, DIGITAL TOOLS AND JUDICIAL BOUNDARY | PLANNING CHAIN | GRAM SABHA PRIORITIES | INTERMEDIATE/DISTRICT CONVERGENCE | DPC CONSOLIDATES PANCHAYAT AND MUNICIPAL PLANS UNDER ARTICLE 243ZD. | ACCOUNTABILITY CHAIN NOTICE + RECORDS + QUORUM/INCLUSION | SOCIAL AUDIT | AUDIT TRAIL

PLANNING CHAIN

Gram Sabha priorities → GPDP → intermediate/district convergence → DPC consolidates Panchayat and municipal plans under Article 243ZD. → ACCOUNTABILITY CHAIN notice + records + quorum/inclusion → social audit → audit trail → follow-up.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PLANNING CHAIN
- Gram Sabha priorities → GPDP → intermediate/district convergence
- DPC consolidates Panchayat and municipal plans under Article 243ZD.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ACCOUNTABILITY CHAIN notice + records + quorum/inclusion → social audit → audit trail → follow-up.
- DIGITAL TOOLS eGramSwaraj planning/accounts
- AuditOnline audit workflow

CHECK / LIMIT
- SVAMITVA survey/property cards
- RGSA capacity building.
- CAUTION portal entry != lawful devolution, informed consent or service quality.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- JUDICIAL BOUNDARY
- Gram Nyayalayas Act, 2008 courts != Gram Sabha or Panchayat institutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gram Nyayalayas Act, 2008 courts != Gram Sabha or Panchayat institutions.

07

STAGE 07 PANCHAYAT-MUNICIPALITY COMPARISON AND CONTROLLING LOCAL-BODY CASES

PANCHAYAT-MUNICIPALITY COMPARISON AND CONTROLLING LOCAL-BODY CASES | PANCHAYATS MUNICIPALITIES | PART IX | ELEVENTH 29 PART IXA | TWELFTH 18 | GRAM SABHA WARD COMMITTEE WHERE ARTICLE 243S APPLIES VILLAGE/INTERMEDIATE/DISTRICT | COMMON CONTROLS | SEC ELECTIONS

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
PANCHAYATS MUNICIPALITIES	Gram Sabha Ward Committee where Article 243S applies village/intermediate/district Nagar Panchayat/Council/Corporation	DPC planning bridge	K. Krishna Murthy (2010) → reservation requires local-body constitutional analysis.
Part IX	COMMON CONTROLS	State-law devolution.	Vikas Kishanrao Gawali (2021) → OBC-reservation triple test.
Eleventh 29 Part IXA	SEC elections	CASE CODE	State of Goa v. Fouzlya Imtiaz Shaikh (2021) → independent SEC.
Twelfth 18	SFC fiscal review	Kishansing Tomar (2006) → timely local elections.	LIMIT cases regulate constitutional boundaries; they do not create one national local law.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PANCHAYATS MUNICIPALITIES
- Part IX
- Eleventh 29 Part IXA
- Twelfth 18

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Gram Sabha Ward Committee where Article 243S applies village/intermediate/district Nagar Panchayat/Council/Corporation
- COMMON CONTROLS
- SEC elections
- SFC fiscal review

CHECK / LIMIT
- DPC planning bridge
- State-law devolution.
- CASE CODE
- Kishansing Tomar (2006) → timely local elections.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- K. Krishna Murthy (2010) → reservation requires local-body constitutional analysis.
- Vikas Kishanrao Gawali (2021) → OBC-reservation triple test.
- State of Goa v. Fouzlya Imtiaz Shaikh (2021) → independent SEC.
- LIMIT cases regulate constitutional boundaries; they do not create one national local law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT cases regulate constitutional boundaries; they do not create one national local law.

08

STAGE 08 EXACT CONTINUITY, TRANSITION AND UNION TERRITORY CONTROLS

EXACT CONTINUITY, TRANSITION AND UNION TERRITORY CONTROLS | ARTICLE 243E FIVE-YEAR TERM | ELECTION BEFORE EXPIRY OR WITHIN SIX MONTHS AFTER DISSOLUTION. | IF THE REMAINDER IS BELOW SIX MONTHS, A SHORT-TERM | A RECONSTITUTED BODY SERVES ONLY THE ORIGINAL UNEXPIRED TERM. | ARTICLE 243L | PRESIDENT MAY APPLY PART IX/T0 A UNION TERRITORY | ARTICLE 243N INCONSISTENT OLD PANCHAYAT LAWS SURVIVED AT MOST

ARTICLE 243E five-year term → election before expiry or within six months after dissolution. → If the remainder is below six months, a short-term election is unnecessary. → A reconstituted body serves only the original unexpired term. → ARTICLE 243L → President may apply Part IX in a Union Territory with exceptions/modifications.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 243E five-year term → election before expiry or within six months after dissolution.
- If the remainder is below six months, a short-term election is unnecessary.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- A reconstituted body serves only the original unexpired term.
- ARTICLE 243L

CHECK / LIMIT
- President may apply Part IX to a Union Territory with exceptions/modifications.
- ARTICLE 243N inconsistent old Panchayat laws survived at most one year from commencement.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- EXAM RULE
- State the proviso with the headline rule; otherwise a true answer remains incomplete.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State the proviso with the headline rule; otherwise a true answer remains incomplete.

09

STAGE 09 SFC, SEC AND SUPREME COURT ACCOUNTABILITY CONTROLS

SFC, SEC AND SUPREME COURT ACCOUNTABILITY CONTROLS | STATE FINANCE COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243I FIVE-YEAR REVIEW | TAX SHARING + ASSIGNMENTS + GRANTS + IMPROVEMENT MEASURES | GOVERNOR LAYS REPORT AND ACTION MEMORANDUM BEFORE THE LEGISLATURE. | STATE ELECTION COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243K ROLLS + ELECTIONS | PROTECTED REMOVAL AND SERVICE CONDITIONS | REQUESTED STATE. | KISHANSING TOMAR (2006)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
STATE FINANCE COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243I five-year review → tax sharing + assignments + grants + improvement measures	STATE ELECTION COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243K rolls + elections → protected removal and service conditions → requested staff.	K. Krishna Murthy (2010) → local empirical basis and reservation ceiling.	State of Goa v. Fouzlya Imtiaz Shaikh (2021) → independent SEC.
Governor lays report and action memorandum before the legislature.	Kishansing Tomar (2006) → timely elections.	Vikas Kishanrao Gawali (2021) → OBC triple test.	STATE FINANCE COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243I five-year review → tax sharing + assignments + grants + improvement measures

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243I five-year review → tax sharing + assignments + grants + improvement measures
- Governor lays report and action memorandum before the legislature.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- STATE ELECTION COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243K rolls + elections → protected removal and service conditions → requested staff.
- Kishansing Tomar (2006) → timely elections.

CHECK / LIMIT
- K. Krishna Murthy (2010) → local empirical basis and reservation ceiling.
- Vikas Kishanrao Gawali (2021) → OBC triple test.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- State of Goa v. Fouzlya Imtiaz Shaikh (2021) → independent SEC.
- STATE FINANCE COMMISSION — ARTICLE 243I five-year review → tax sharing + assignments + grants + improvement measures

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State of Goa v. Fouzlya Imtiaz Shaikh (2021) → independent SEC.

10

STAGE 10 DATED EVIDENCE, ANSWER COMPRESSION AND REFORM OWNERSHIP

DATED EVIDENCE, ANSWER COMPRESSION AND REFORM OWNERSHIP | DATED PRIMARY CONTROLS — CHECKED 28 AUGUST 2026 | DEVOLUTION INDEX REPORT 2024 | COMPARATIVE DEVOLUTION FRAMEWORK. | XIXTEENTH FINANCE COMMISSION 2026-31 | LOCAL-BODY FISCAL FRAMEWORK. | MINISTRY PESA-RULES DIRECTORY | NOTIFICATION STATUS, NOT FIELD COMPLIANCE.

State legislature devolves	Panchayat executes	Gram Sabha scrutinises
SFC recommends	SEC conducts elections	courts enforce boundaries.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- DATED PRIMARY CONTROLS — CHECKED 28 AUGUST 2026
- Devolution Index Report 2024 → comparative devolution framework.
- Sixteenth Finance Commission 2026-31 → local-body fiscal framework.
- Ministry PESA-rules directory → notification status, not field compliance.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ANSWER COMPRESSION
- 10 marks → rule + mechanism + one gap + verdict.
- 15 marks → constitutional chain + evidence + counterpoint + reforms.
- 20 marks → evolution + design + three Fs + PESA + cases + phased reform.

CHECK / LIMIT
- ACTOR MAP
- State legislature devolves
- Panchayat executes
- Gram Sabha scrutinises

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SFC recommends
- SEC conducts elections
- courts enforce boundaries.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 10 marks → rule + mechanism + one gap + verdict.

11

STAGE 11 IMPLEMENTATION GAPS, REFORM SEQUENCE, PYQ ROUTES AND FINAL SYNTHESIS

IMPLEMENTATION GAPS, REFORM SEQUENCE, PYQ ROUTES AND FINAL SYNTHESIS | DIAGNOSIS REGULAR ELECTIONS + REPRESENTATION GAINS BUT VAGUE ACTIVITY | REFORM SEQUENCE BINDING ACTIVITY MAP | ACCOUNTABLE LOCAL CADRE | PREDICTABLE UNTIED FINANCE | FAIR OWN-REVENUE REFORM | STRONG GRAM SABHA | AUDIT/SOCIAL AUDIT

DIAGNOSIS regular elections + representation gains but vague activity maps + departmental staff + weak. → REFORM SEQUENCE binding activity map → accountable local cadre → predictable untied finance → fair own-revenue reform → strong Gram Sabha → audit/social audit → assisted digital access → outcome-based GPDP. → PYQ ROUTES finance beyond grants

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- DIAGNOSIS regular elections + representation gains but vague activity maps + departmental staff + weak own revenue + delayed SFCs.
- REFORM SEQUENCE binding activity map → accountable local cadre → predictable untied finance
- fair own-revenue reform → strong Gram Sabha → audit/social audit

POWER / PROCEDURE
- assisted digital access → outcome-based GPDP.
- PYQ ROUTES finance beyond grants
- women and patriarchy

CHECK / LIMIT
- three Fs to functionality intermediate-tier exception
- PESA banks.
- MAINS SPINE define decentralisation → cite Part IX → explain mechanism → show gap

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- named case/current anchor → State-variation qualification → functionality verdict.
- SYNTHESIS representation becomes self-government only when authority, staff and money converge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS representation becomes self-government only when authority, staff and money converge.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | PART A — EVOLUTION | PART B — 73RD AMENDMENT ACT, 1992 | PART C — PESA ACT, 1996 | LAXMIKANT FRAMES GRAM SABHA AS THE PARTICIPATORY-DEMOCRACY CORE OF | SEC 17 OF MGNREGA MANDATES GRAM SABHA MONITORING AND SOCIAL AUDIT MEANS COMMUNITY VERIFICATION OF RECORDS, EXPENDITURE AND | MEGHALAYA ENACTED THE MEGHALAYA COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION AND PUBLIC SERVICES

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- PART A — EVOLUTION
- PART B — 73rd AMENDMENT ACT, 1992
- PART C — PESA ACT, 1996
- Laxmikant frames Gram Sabha as the participatory-democracy core of Panchayati Raj.

ADVANCED LIMIT
- Sec 17 of MGNREGA mandates Gram Sabha monitoring and regular social audits of works within the Gram Panchayat.
- CAUTION: Social audit means community verification of records, expenditure and outcomes — not merely departmental inspection.
- Meghalaya enacted the Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017, widely cited as the first state social-audit law.
- NOT: 73rd Amendment came into force in 1992 — passed 1992; in force 24 April 1993 .

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- NOT: Eleventh Schedule has 29 items for municipalities -> 29 for panchayats (Twelfth Schedule = 18 for
- NOT: All 3 tiers are compulsory for every state -> a state < 20 lakh may skip the intermediate tier.
- NOT: Only village-level territorial seats are directly elected -> territorial seats at all
- NOT: Minimum candidate age is 25 -> 21 for panchayats.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.